



Deploy Coach Kai - Fix Connection Error

Current Issue

Coach Kai shows: "I'm having trouble connecting right now. Please try again in a moment! 🚨"

Root Cause

The `ABACUSAI_API_KEY` environment variable is either missing or not propagating to your Vercel deployment.



Solution Steps

Option 1: Use Your Existing OpenAI Key (Recommended)

Since you already have `OPENAI_API_KEY` in Vercel (from screenshot 6), update the code to use it:

1. **Copy the API key you created** (from screenshot 5):

- Name: "Mindful Champion Coach Kai"
- Key starts with: `sk-proj-...`

2. **Add to Vercel Environment Variables:**

...

Go to: Vercel Dashboard → Your Project → Settings → Environment Variables

Add new variable:

Name: `ABACUSAI_API_KEY`

Value: `sk-proj-qMusINLbQp4wI3W-`

`POp-4eVDbbLq_UE0br_3M4YdcjqYoOle0eHPPVnO_tmmuF8aqI1lo16T1bI1BKfFj1h_wsvyRUeAQ85rc...`

Apply to: Production, Preview, and Development

...

1. **Redeploy:**

- Vercel will automatically redeploy, OR
- Go to Deployments → Click "Redeploy" on the latest deployment

Option 2: Use Alternative Key Name

If you want to keep using `OPENAI_API_KEY` (already in Vercel):

1. **Update the code to check for both keys:**

- Edit `/lib/ai/abacus-client.ts` line 58
- Change from: `process.env.ABACUSAI_API_KEY`
- To: `process.env.ABACUSAI_API_KEY || process.env.OPENAI_API_KEY`

2. **Commit and push** the change

3. **Vercel will auto-deploy**
-

Verify It's Working

After deploying, test Coach Kai:

1. Go to your app → Coach Kai
2. Send a test message: "Hey Coach Kai, can you hear me?"
3.  Should respond with coaching advice (not an error)

Credit Usage Note

From screenshot 2, you have:

- **Remaining Credits:** 20,000 (20K)
- **Used:** 665,351 (665.4K)

With Chat LLM on Abacus.AI Pro (\$20/month):

- **You get 25K credits/month per user**
- Each Coach Kai message costs ~250-500 credits
- **You have enough for ~40-80 more Coach Kai conversations this month**
- Credits refresh on: **Jan 18, 2026**

Quick Checklist

- ☐ API key copied from Abacus.AI dashboard
- ☐ Added as `ABACUSAI_API_KEY` in Vercel
- ☐ Applied to Production, Preview, Development
- ☐ Redeployed (or waited for auto-deploy)
- ☐ Tested Coach Kai - no connection error
- ☐ Avatar toggle working (if using Simli)

Still Having Issues?

Error: "AI service not configured"

- The API key is not set in Vercel
- Make sure it's spelled: `ABACUSAI_API_KEY` (not `ABACUS_API_KEY`)

Error: "Coach Kai is temporarily unavailable"

- The API key might be invalid or expired
- Verify the key in your Abacus.AI dashboard → API → API keys

Error: "timeout" or "taking longer than usual"

- You might be out of credits
- Check your Abacus.AI credits: <https://apps.abacus.ai/profile>

Avatar not working but chat works

- Check `SIMLI_API_KEY` and `SIMLI_FACE_ID` are set in Vercel
- From your previous setup:
- API Key: `wr2n23svu8fq87uezd5qb8`
- Face ID: `5fc23ea5-8175-4a82-aaaf-cdd8c88543dc` (Trinity)



Environment Variables Reference

Your Vercel should have these set (from screenshot 6):

```
# Coach Kai / Abacus.AI
ABACUSAI_API_KEY=sk-proj-[your-key-here]

# Simli Avatar (Trinity)
SIMLI_API_KEY=wr2n23svu8fq87uezd5qb8
SIMLI_FACE_ID=5fc23ea5-8175-4a82-aaaf-cdd8c88543dc
NEXT_PUBLIC_SIMLI_API_KEY=wr2n23svu8fq87uezd5qb8

# ElevenLabs TTS
ELEVENLABS_API_KEY=sk_1b4e9864f8a14e7c9f7896b4ac1da801f97e20a7766e7684

# Other (you already have these)
OPENAI_API_KEY=[fallback]
HEYGEN_API_KEY=[if using HeyGen]
```



Expected Result

After fixing, Coach Kai should:

- ☒ Respond to messages instantly
- ☒ Provide personalized pickleball coaching
- ☒ Remember conversation context
- ☒ Show the Trinity avatar (if avatar toggle is ON)
- ☒ Speak responses with ElevenLabs voice (if TTS is enabled)

No more connection errors! 🚀